



PHOTOGRAPHS BY CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times
JOSÉ ANTONIO Rodríguez, 44, right, hugs his mother, Juana Contreras Sanchez, after 24 years apart.

COLUMN ONE

Separated by a border for decades, they finally get their embraces

Rare visas reunite undocumented workers and their parents

By Kate Linthicum

José Antonio Rodríguez held a bouquet in his trembling hands. It had been nearly a quarter of a century since he had left his family behind in Mexico to seek work in California. In all those years, he hadn't seen his parents once. They kept in touch as best they could, but letters took months to cross the border, and his father never was one for phone calls. Visits were impossible: José was undocumented, and his parents lacked visas to come to the U.S. Now, after years of separation, they were about to be



A GIFT for families hailing from Mexico's Zacatecas state and reconnecting after years.

reunited. And José's stomach was in knots. He had been a young man of 20 when he left home, skinny and full of ambition. Now he was 44, thicker around the middle, his hair thinning at the temples. Would his parents recognize him? Would he recognize them? What would they think of his life? José had spent weeks preparing for this moment, cleaning his trailer in the Inland Empire from top to bottom and clearing the weeds from his yard. He bought new [See Reunion, A4]

Why police fear the 'Grim Reaper'

Internal Affairs detective has become a lightning rod of controversy

By Libor Jany

In a police department with a long tradition of colorful nicknames — from "Jigsaw John" to "Captain Hollywood" — LAPD Sgt. Joseph Lloyd stands out. "The Grim Reaper." At least that's what some on the force have taken to calling the veteran Internal Affairs detective, usually out

of earshot. According to officers who have found themselves under investigation by Lloyd, he seems to relish the moniker and takes pleasure in ending careers, even if it means twisting facts and ignoring evidence. But Lloyd's backers maintain his dogged pursuit of the truth is why he has been entrusted with some of the department's most po-

litically sensitive and potentially embarrassing cases. Lloyd, 52, declined to comment. But The Times spoke to more than half a dozen current or former police officials who either worked alongside him or fell under his scrutiny. During the near decade that he's been in Internal Affairs, Lloyd has investigated cops of all ranks. When a since-retired

LAPD officer was suspected of running guns across the Mexican border, the department turned to Lloyd to bust him. In 2020, when it came out that members of the elite Metropolitan Division were falsely labeling civilians as gang members in a police database, Lloyd was tapped to help unravel the mess. And when a San Fer- [See LAPD, A10]

Will Newsom's bold remapping move pay off?

Governor's political gambit could boost his 2028 ambitions. But it also carries great risk.

By Julia Wick

Deep in the badlands of defeat, Democrats have soul-searched about what went wrong last November, tinkered with a thousand-plus think pieces and desperately cast for a strategy to reboot their stalled-out party. Amid the noise, California Gov. Gavin Newsom has recently championed an unlikely game plan: Forget the high road, fight fire with fire and embrace the very tactics that virtue-minded Democrats have long decried. Could the dark art of political gerrymandering be the thing that saves democracy from Trump's increasingly authoritarian impulses? That's essentially the pitch Newsom is making

to California voters with his audacious new special election campaign. As Texas Democrats dig in to block a Republican-led redistricting push and Trump muscles to consolidate power wherever he can, Newsom wants to redraw California's own congressional districts to favor Democrats. His goal: counter Trump's drive for more GOP House seats with a power play of his own. It's a boundary-pushing gamble that will undoubtedly supercharge Newsom's political star in the short term. The long-game glory could be even grander, but only if he pulls it off. A ballot-box flop would be brutal for [See Newsom, A8]

They're more willing to fight With redistricting push, Democrats turn words into action. **NATION, A8**

Trump appears to be on Putin's page

President agrees that a peace accord could be reached with Ukraine ceding land.

By Michael Wilner

ANCHORAGE — President Trump made his expectations clear entering a summit with Vladimir Putin in Alaska on Friday: "I won't be happy if I walk away without some form of a ceasefire," he said aboard Air Force One. Yet he did, emerging from their meeting in a diplomatic retreat, endorsing Russia's territorial ambitions and adopting Putin's position that would put off ceasefire negotiations in favor of more comprehensive talks. Trump told his European counterparts he had agreed with Putin's demand that Ukraine make territorial concessions to end the con-

flict, a painful prospect for Ukrainians at the heart of the war, a European official told The Times on Saturday. Trump also wrote on social media that he would adopt the Kremlin line deferring talks on an imminent ceasefire. "It was determined by all that the best way to end the horrific war between Russia and Ukraine is to go directly to a Peace Agreement, which would end the war, and not a mere Ceasefire Agreement, which often times do not hold up," Trump wrote on social media. "If all works out, we will then schedule a meeting [See Summit, A7]

Zelensky, Trump to meet Monday Ukrainian president will visit the White House after the inconclusive Putin summit. **WORLD, A3**



STEVE GONZALEZ California Department of Fish and Wildlife
MAMA BEAR rested long enough to give birth near Topanga Canyon. She has traveled at least 100 miles.

This mobile bear has been on quite a star trek

By Andrew J. Campa

The travel pattern resembled a Southern California hiker's dream. The journey began in Angeles National Forest above Glendora in May 2024 and progressed south into Azusa. There were stops, stays and starts from Monrovia and Sierra Madre, then northeast into La Cañada Flintridge, Tujunga and, eventually, the Santa Clarita Valley. The route then turned southward into the Santa

Susana Mountains, Simi Hills and then the Santa Monica Mountains before a couple of beach days and a return trip home. But this trek — at least 100 miles — wasn't some bucket list excursion or "only in L.A." Instagram story. It was completed not by a hiker, but a roughly 175-pound female black bear known as Yellow 2291. The 5- to 7-year-old with a penchant for media coverage was recently spotted by Topanga residents with three cubs, making the quar- [See Bear, A10]

Californians seek new start — in Oklahoma

Tulsa is luring remote workers with low costs. And hard cash.

By Hannah Fry



SEPTEMBER DAWN BOTTOMS For The Times
THE PROGRAM Tulsa Remote offers remote workers \$10,000 to move to Oklahoma for at least a year.

about a program, Tulsa Remote, that pays remote workers to relocate to Oklahoma's second-largest city for at least a year. She decided to give it a shot and visit. By November 2020, Rollins was a full-time resident in the Sooner State. Tulsa Remote has attracted more than 3,600 remote workers since its inception in 2019. More than 7,800 Californians have applied to the program and 539 have made the move, cementing California as the second-most popular origin state behind Texas. More Californians have moved to Tulsa through the program than those hailing from other coastal states such as Florida and New York. Similar programs have popped up in Alabama, Kansas, Arkansas, West Virginia and other states looking to [See Oklahoma, A12]

Journalists are hit despite order
Reporters say they were struck by LAPD officers' batons after a federal judge restricted use of force. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Paramount boss aims to rebuild
David Ellison plans to make big investments, lean into technology and build on popular franchises. **BUSINESS, A11**

Danielle Brooks' year to remember
After success in "A Minecraft Movie" and "The Bad Guys 2," actor takes on "Peacemaker." **ENTERTAINMENT, E4**

Weather
Some sunshine. L.A. Basin: 81/64. **B8**

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